

Google Cloud Interview Prep Guide: Customer Engineer Specialist

Our hiring process

There's no one kind of Googler, so we're always looking for people who can bring new perspectives and experiences to our teams. If you're looking for a place that values your curiosity, passion, and desire to learn, if you're seeking colleagues who are big thinkers eager to take on fresh challenges as a team, you may be a future Googler.

The Interview

The Google Cloud Customer Engineer interview process consists of four interviews over two days, completed within one week. Candidate experience is our top priority, so we're able to make timeline adjustments as needed to accommodate your interviewing availability. **Note: Round 2 interview is contingent upon feedback from Round 1.*

Round one:

- General Cognitive Ability (45 Minutes)
- Role Related Knowledge (60 Minutes)
- Googlyness & Leadership (45 minutes)

Round two:

- Presentation (45 minutes)

General Cognitive Ability: This interview is designed to evaluate how you solve problems. There are no "right" or "wrong" GCA solutions; rather, we're interested in observing the data-driven approach you take to identify a logical recommendation, with the ability to support your solution.

We suggest following this 4-step framework:

1. Show you understand the problem by asking clarifying questions to get additional context. If you don't get a direct answer to your question, leverage assumptions to begin creating tangible information to work with.

Build for everyone

2. Prepare by verbalizing the data needed to identify a solution — this may include existing, historical or new data. Be clear about where you might seek existing data points or how you might gather new information.
3. Identify a solution. Feel free to weigh options, but ultimately convey your recommendation.
4. Support your solution. What was the outcome or result? Explain how you would track effectiveness over time.

The questions during this interview may be hypothetical, behavioral, or technical in nature.

- Hypothetical questions may be entirely unrelated to your experience.
- Behavioral questions may ask you for real-life examples of times where you had to think outside the box to overcome challenges.
- Technical questions may include a mock customer scenario where you're asked how to identify the appropriate solution.

Sample questions:

1. Behavioral: Give me an example of a time when you had to address a complicated technical problem for a customer without an obvious solution.

2. Hypothetical: Imagine you're tasked with improving customer satisfaction from 80% to 90%, without additional resources or tools. How would you go about doing this?

Role Related Knowledge: With Role-Related Knowledge (RRK), we'll dig into three primary areas: consultative skills, cloud foundational knowledge and technical depth. This interview won't include coding, but you should be prepared to illustrate solutions on a whiteboard. In addition to evaluating your broad knowledge of cloud technologies, interviewers will evaluate your depth in the domain area of the specialist role to which you're applying.

Each specialist RRK interview is different. Use the index below to navigate to the appropriate role, and use the info provided as a starting point for your preparation. If you're unclear which role you're interviewing for, ask your recruiter.

Although you're encouraged to leverage your hands-on experience across any cloud platforms, it's recommended to study the Google Cloud Platform (GCP), and be able to tie your experience into GCP tools and offerings. We highly recommend studying [GCP whitepapers](#) and using your Gmail account to play around in the console, if applicable.

You'll want to brush up on the following:

- **Consultative Skills**
 - You will be asked questions designed to assess how you conduct or contribute to customer meetings and interact with stakeholders in the sales process.
 - Topics could include: Preparation for customer meetings, evaluating opportunities and Handling customer objections.
- **Cloud Foundational knowledge**
 - The value of cloud computing and fully serverless solutions
 - The pros and cons of IaaS, PaaS, and SaaS (how would you advise a customer on the appropriate solution?)
 - Cloud security concepts as they relate to the migration of enterprise workloads
- **Technical depth & Whiteboarding**
 - You may be asked to lead a mock customer session during the interview.
 - Be prepared to illustrate your architectural strategy on a whiteboard.
 - Be prepared for questions related to your choices, which may touch on storage, availability, scalability, disaster recovery, migration, and their relative costs.
 - You should be able to support your decisions and provide opinions.
 - Be transparent about the things you don't have hands-on experience with.

Googleness: Share how you work individually and on a team, how you help others, how you navigate ambiguity, and how you push yourself to grow outside of your comfort zone.

Leadership: Be prepared to discuss how you've used your communication and decision-making skills to mobilize others. This might be by stepping up to a leadership role at work or with an organization, or by helping a team succeed even when you weren't officially the leader.

Presentation: Prepare a 7-slide presentation on a technical solution you've proposed or implemented to solve a business problem in your current or previous role. The presentation will assess your sales skills; specifically, your ability to deliver a presentation and represent Google to the customer. Your presentation should not exceed **30 minutes**, allowing time for Q&A.

**Additional details found on the Google Cloud Interview Prep Guide: Presentation Prompt document.*

Why Google

Google Cloud provides organizations with leading infrastructure, platform capabilities and industry solutions, along with expertise, to reinvent their business with data-powered innovation on modern computing infrastructure. We deliver enterprise-grade cloud solutions that leverage Google's cutting-edge technology to help companies operate more efficiently, modernize for growth and innovate for the future. Customers in more than 150 countries turn to Google Cloud as their trusted partner to solve their most critical business problems.

Interview Warmup

Interview Warmup is a tool that lets anyone practice answering interview questions to get more confident and comfortable with the interview process. Your answers are transcribed in real time so you can review what you said and discover patterns in your responses. Click [here](#) to start practicing.

Connect with a Googler

Interested in learning more about what it's like to work at Google? Let your recruiter know and they'll set you up for a phone call with a Googler in your field of expertise for an insider's perspective on everything from technology to culture, and more. This call is not an interview, a coaching call or a fit call, but rather an informal 30-minute conversation with volunteers who are not part of the hiring process.

Additional Resources

GCP Product Knowledge

[Google Cloud products](#)
[Google Cloud customers \(customer highlights\)](#)
[Google Cloud Next](#)
[GCP Latest Stories](#)
[Google Cloud Architecture Center](#)

About Us

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[Life at Google Youtube Channel](#)

Specialist-specific RRK prep material

[Infrastructure Modernization](#)

[Google Workspace](#)

Build for everyone

Application Modernization

Data Analytics

Data Management

SAP

Networking

Machine Learning

Security and Compliance

Infrastructure Modernization

Infrastructure Modernization Specialists provide deep technical expertise in focused areas of: on-premise to cloud migrations, virtual machine migrations, disaster recovery, and high availability.

The Infrastructure Modernization Specialist RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of cloud, cloud services platform ecosystem, cloud infrastructure architectures, migrations from on-premise to cloud migrations, scalability, and disaster recovery planning.

Your interviewer will assess your breadth of knowledge and experience working with different migration types. Consider lift and shift, move and improve, or rebuild options.

Concepts to understand

- How to migrate an enterprise workload into the cloud
- Disaster recovery and availability from a cloud standpoint
- Large scale data center migrations
- Infrastructure
- Deployment tools

GCP technologies to study up on

- [Compute Engine](#)
- [Anthos](#)
- [The Google Cloud Adoption Framework](#)
- [Google Cloud Deployment Manager](#)

Other suggested links

- [Application Migration \(GCP\)](#)
- [Data center migration \(GCP\)](#)

Application Modernization

Application Modernization Cloud Specialists provide deep technical expertise in focused areas of: application development (AppDev), developer operations (DevOps), microservices, continuous integration/delivery (CI/CD), and aspects of information security (InfoSec).

Your Application Modernization Cloud Specialist RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of cloud, cloud services platform ecosystem, cloud application architectures, migrations from on-premise to cloud migration, microservices, and container deployments.

Concepts to understand

- Cloud services platform ecosystem on GCP (Anthos)
- Cloud migration
- Cloud Security
- DevOps
- Monolithic vs. microservices application architectures
- Cloud native applications
- Container Orchestration
- Serverless CI/CD, automation, configuration management

GCP technologies

- [Kubernetes Engine](#)
- [Deployment Manager](#)
- [Firebase](#)
- [Google Cloud's operations suite \(formerly Stackdriver\)](#)
- [Trust & Security](#)
- [BeyondCorp](#)
- [Memorystore](#)

Other suggested links

- [DevOps Solutions \(GCP\)](#)
- [Google Cloud Whitepapers](#)

Data Analytics

Analytics Specialists assist with customer adoption of Big Data & Analytics, and provide the subject-matter expertise around GCP Big Data products to help accelerate adoption and assist customers with their Big Data journey, including time-to-insights.

Your interviewer will assess your breadth of knowledge and experience working with big data systems, use cases and the depth of your knowledge in big data architecture and measurement.

Concepts to understand

- Enterprise Data Warehousing
 - Data warehouse and data lake migrations
 - Data warehouse use cases, performance and management
- Data processing frameworks
- Batch and real-time streaming analytics
- SQL versus NoSQL use cases and use case patterns
- Enterprise data governance and metadata management

GCP technologies to study up on

- [BigQuery](#)
- [Big Data Portfolio](#)
- [Big Data Solutions](#)

Other suggested links

- [GCP Data Analytics blog](#)

Data Management

Data Management Specialists help clients understand data center network topologies, enterprise security and cloud identity. They recommend integration strategies, enterprise architectures, platforms and application infrastructure required to successfully implement a complete cloud solution.

Your Database Management RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of databases. This may include database migrations, database performance tuning, database design, and troubleshooting.

Concepts to understand

- Database High Availability & Disaster Recovery
- SQL Analysis and Optimization
- Database Use Cases
- Database Tuning & Optimization
- Database Migrations (what are the challenges when migrating to the cloud?)
- Database Architectures
- SQL and NoSQL options on the market, specifically GCP

GCP technologies to study up on

- [Cloud SQL](#)
- [Spanner](#)
- [BigTable](#)
- [Datastore](#)
- [Memorystore](#)

Other suggested links

- [Google Cloud Whitepapers](#)

Google Workspace

Google Workspace Specialists assist with customer adoption of all of Google Cloud Collaboration tools (Email, Docs, Drive, etc.) and provide the subject matter expertise around GCP Workspace products to help accelerate customers to work in a whole new way. Competitors include Microsoft 365, Box, and Workplace by Facebook.

Your Workspace Specialist RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of cloud platform and SaaS products, particularly communication and collaboration tools.

Concepts to understand

- Transformation and Change Management
- Real time communications paradigms such as Chat and Video Conference
- Electronic Discovery
- Email Systems
 - Email systems architecture
 - Email encryption techniques
 - Phishing mitigation
- Cloud Identity and Access Management
 - Multi Factor Authentication
 - Single SignOn
 - SAML (Security Assertion Markup Language)
- Endpoint Management
 - Mobile Device Management
 - Zero Trust Security Model
- Third Party Integrations

Suggested links

- [Google Workspace Overview](#)
- [Google Workspace Security and Compliance](#)

Machine Learning

Machine Learning Specialists will meet the customer where they are and take them on the journey to a production machine learning application.

Your Machine Learning Specialist RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of cloud, experience in big data analytics in a cloud environment, and understanding of machine learning technologies.

Concepts to understand

- The value proposition of Google AI
- The value proposition of Cloud Machine Learning Engine and how it works
- Framing ML Conversations
- Architecting ML Solutions
- Building AI-Driven Applications
- Building Production ML Pipelines
- Business challenges specific to Machine Learning

Suggested links

- [AI and machine learning products](#)
- [Cloud AI Platform](#)

Security and Compliance

Security and Compliance Specialists interact directly with customers and our sales teams to unblock deals where security and compliance are critically important. This includes giving security briefings, technical deep dives, and targeted customer engagement to facilitate the adoption of Google Cloud.

Your Security and Compliance Specialist RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of cloud security and compliance. In the interview you will discuss various aspects of designing and running a secure cloud application. Although technical, this interview won't include coding questions.

Concepts to understand

- Data protection
- Identity and access management
- Network security
- Typical security threats to Cloud environments and mitigation techniques
- Compliance (e.g., ISO 27001, SOC 2 and 3, FedRAMP, PCI DSS, HIPAA, and GDPR)

GCP technologies to study up on

- [Google Cloud Security](#)
- [Google Cloud Compliance resource center](#)
- [Google Cloud Security best practices center](#)

Other suggested links

- [Google Cloud Whitepapers](#)

Networking

Networking Specialists evangelize Google's Network and managed services, accelerating Google Cloud Adoption. In this role, you'll map existing architectures to Google Cloud.

Your Networking Specialist RRK interview will dig into your broad knowledge of networking solutions. This may include routing and switching, application networking, and network security.

Concepts to understand

- How cloud networking differs from traditional enterprise networking or legacy architectures
- The differences between layers
- Application Networking
 - Various approaches for hybrid cloud networking
 - How to troubleshoot and scale applications
- OS/Linux Networking
- Network Security
- Networking business challenges

GCP technologies to study up on

- [Google Virtual Private Cloud \(VPC\)](#) fundamentals, features, and architectures
- [Google Cloud Hybrid Connectivity](#)
- [Cloud DNS](#)
- [Cloud Load Balancing](#)
- [Cloud CDN](#)

Other suggested links

- [Google Cloud Whitepapers](#)

SAP

SAP Specialists interact with our sales teams and customers to run technical discovery sessions, interactive workshops, and assist customers with architecting their SAP environments on Google Cloud. This also includes helping customers with SAP proof of concepts and pilots running on the platform during pre-sales engagements.

Your SAP Specialist RRK interview will assess your broad knowledge of SAP solutions, including infrastructure knowledge, SAP architecture and design, and SAP migration methodologies.

Although technical, this interview won't include coding questions. To prepare for this interview, think about how you would illustrate SAP solutions on a whiteboard. Interviewers will ask you questions related to your choices, which may touch on compute, storage, availability, scalability, disaster recovery, migration and their relative costs. You should be able to set a direction and support your decisions.

Your interviewer will assess your breadth of cloud knowledge in SAP landscapes and technical architecture for applications, infrastructure and application development, and cloud security concepts as it relates to the migration of enterprise workload.

Be prepared to discuss in-depth any areas where you've identified yourself as an expert on your resume. Research and be prepared to discuss:

- The unique value proposition of [Google Cloud](#)
- The technical resources for running [SAP on Google Cloud](#)
- Understand why [customers](#) are moving SAP to Google Cloud, and the [benefits](#)
- Business challenges specific to SAP Migrations, how you can support clients during migrations.